

Saturday, 12 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 23° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 20° 12°	MANCHESTER Light rain 21° 12°	GLASGOW Rain 18° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

MPs have voted against a fresh attempt to legalise assisted dying in the UK, rejecting a proposed law that sought to introduce one of the biggest societal changes in recent years.

The vote in Parliament saw the bill defeated, meaning the current laws on assisted dying remain unchanged. This issue has been a subject of intense debate across the country for some time.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Police forces across the UK are preparing to crack down on the use of face coverings at protests, using powers under the Crime and Policing Act.

Hampshire and Isle of Wight Constabulary has confirmed it will be implementing these measures. The move aims to address concerns about public order and identification at demonstrations.

LAW · UK
- 3

A man has admitted to the murder of a woman who went missing 28 years ago, bringing an end to a long-running cold case.

Trevor Dunkley told police he killed Patricia Lashley in 1998 and then disposed of her body months later. The court heard details of his confession, finally offering some answers to her family.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Girls in Northern Ireland schools will soon have a legal right to wear trousers as part of their uniform, following new guidelines.

From the 2027/28 school year, uniform policies must include the option for girls to wear trousers. This marks a significant change for school dress codes across the region.

EDUCATION · UK
- 5

The UK government has rejected the idea of a 'kill switch' for dangerous artificial intelligence, stating it cannot simply turn AI off.

The Cabinet Office, which leads on AI safety, made the announcement, highlighting the complexities of controlling advanced AI systems. This decision comes amidst ongoing global discussions about AI regulation.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

What's coming up

1 **Stacey Solomon and Alesha Dixon are set to take over as the new hosts of The Voice UK, as ITV revamps the popular singing competition.**

The much-loved duo will replace Emma Willis, who is stepping down after hosting the show since 2014. It's an exciting new chapter for the show and its fans!

ON AIR – What do we think of Stacey and Alesha taking over? Are they the perfect pairing for The Voice UK?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Oasis have teased a major tour announcement, with a spectacular drone display lighting up the sky over Manchester last night.**

The band illuminated the Etihad's Joie Stadium, home to Manchester City Women, with a display that has fans buzzing about a potential reunion tour. Could we be seeing Liam and Noel back on stage together soon?

ON AIR – Are you hoping for an Oasis reunion tour? Which classic songs would you most want to hear live again?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Maisie Williams and Joey King, stars of the upcoming Practical Magic reboot, say people are longing for simpler times.**

The actresses feature in the sequel to the beloved 1998 fantasy romcom, which is generating a lot of buzz. It sounds like a perfect dose of magic and nostalgia!

ON AIR – Are you excited for the Practical Magic reboot? What other classic films would you love to see get a sequel?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Harry Styles has extended his 'Together, Together' tour, adding 25 new dates, with Kylie Minogue joining him as a support act.**

The pop superstar will play three additional shows in London, giving even more fans a chance to see him live. And with Kylie on board, it's going to be an incredible night out!

ON AIR – Harry Styles and Kylie Minogue on the same bill – what a dream team! Who would be your ultimate support act for Harry?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **The new Strictly Come Dancing hosts have explained their roles, rejecting reports of them being 'roving presenters' for the upcoming series.**

Johannes Radebe, Josh Widdicombe, and Emma Willis clarified that their roles are not 'fixed' or strictly defined. It sounds like they're ready to bring some fresh energy to the ballroom!

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to the new Strictly Come Dancing series? What do you think of the new hosting line-up?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Young British driver Arvid Lindblad crashed his Racing Bulls in Friday practice at the Spanish Grand Prix, where Kimi Antonelli set the fastest time.**

Lindblad's incident caused a red flag, but thankfully he was unhurt. Meanwhile, Antonelli's impressive pace suggests a thrilling qualifying session is on the cards.

ON AIR – It's all happening in F1! Will Kimi Antonelli be able to convert his practice speed into a strong qualifying performance?

FORMULA 1 · UK

2 **Brilliant Shane Lowry has surged clear at the Irish Open, carding a course-record 62 to take control of the tournament.**

Defending champion Rory McIlroy, however, struggled with his putting, preventing him from making a second-round charge. Lowry is certainly in fine form on home soil!

ON AIR – What a round from Shane Lowry! Do you think he can maintain this incredible form and secure the Irish Open title?

GOLF · UK

3 **Manchester United recorded their biggest Champions League victory since 2020, sweeping Sabah FK aside at Old Trafford last night.**

The Red Devils put four goals past their opponents in a dominant performance, marking a strong return to the competition. Fans will be delighted with such a convincing win.

ON AIR – Manchester United are back in the Champions League with a bang! How far do you think they can go in the competition this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **England's Dan Lawrence and Jordan Cox both produced brilliant, diving catches to dismiss Shan Masood and Babar Azam in the Third Test.**

The spectacular catches came on day three at Edgbaston, helping England make crucial breakthroughs against Pakistan. Their fielding has been absolutely top-notch!

ON AIR – Some incredible fielding from England! Which do you think was the better catch, Lawrence's or Cox's?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Celtic players received a 'timely reminder' from Police Scotland about their 'general behaviour' ahead of Sunday's derby against Rangers.**

Manager Martin O'Neill revealed the visit, highlighting the intense rivalry between the two Glasgow clubs. It's always a fiery fixture, and security is clearly a priority.

ON AIR – The Glasgow Derby is always huge! What are your predictions for Celtic versus Rangers this weekend?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people creating 'miniature garden scenes' inside glass cloches or old teapots.**
These charming, tiny landscapes are proving a delightful way to bring a touch of greenery indoors, perfect for windowsills or desks.
- 2 The humble art of 'doodling while on the phone' is being celebrated as a genuine creativity booster.**
Experts suggest that these unconscious sketches can actually help us focus and process information better during conversations.
- 3 Families are rediscovering the joy of 'board game evenings' as a screen-free way to connect and have fun.**
Sales of classic board games and new releases are soaring, with many enjoying the shared laughter and friendly competition.
- 4 A quirky initiative is encouraging communities to 'swap homegrown produce' with their neighbours.**
From excess courgettes to fresh herbs, it's a lovely way to reduce waste and foster local connections.
- 5 Many are embracing the simple pleasure of 'writing a journal' to document their daily thoughts and feelings.**
It's a wonderful, reflective practice that helps to organise your mind and appreciate the small moments in life.
- 6 The unexpected delight of 'watching clouds' is being championed as a mindful way to relax.**
Taking a moment to observe the ever-changing shapes in the sky can be surprisingly calming and imaginative.
- 7 A report highlights the growing popularity of 'local history walks' in towns and villages across the UK.**
People are enjoying discovering fascinating stories and hidden gems right on their doorstep, often led by enthusiastic local volunteers.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of chocolate will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING IT VERY INTENTLY, AS IF OUR NOSE CAN TELL US HOW DELICIOUS IT WILL BE.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm cup of soup, especially if it's a new flavour. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES, THEN ANTI-CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES, FOR 'GOOD MEASURE'.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'sound from nature' just instantly puts you at ease or brings a smile to your face, no matter what?**

Whether it's the gentle pitter-patter of rain, the chirping of birds, or the rustling of leaves, what's that one natural sound that always makes you feel good, and why?

- **We all have that 'one comfort food' that, no matter how old we get, can still instantly transport us back to our childhood or a happy memory, don't we?**

What's your ultimate comfort food, and what wonderful memories does it bring bubbling back to the surface for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** During World War II, carrots were promoted by the British government as a healthy food that improved eyesight, partly to mask the real reason for pilots' improved night vision, which was the development of radar.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded 'traffic light' was installed in London in 1868, just outside the Houses of Parliament, and was manually operated using gas lamps.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically 1/100th of a second.
- The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall, but rather a collection of walls and fortifications.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- A flock of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Bubble wrap was originally invented in 1957 as 3D wallpaper.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.

On this day

Day 255 of the year, 110 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ailbe (Elvis, Eilfyw) of Emly; Christian feast day: Guy of Anderlecht; Christian feast day: The Most Holy Name of the Blessed Virgin Mary; Christian feast day: John Henry Hobart (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1980 — Kevin Sinfield, English rugby player
- 1986 — Emmy Rossum, American singer and actress
- 1938 — Judy Clay, American soul and gospel singer (died 2001)
- 1972 — Gideon Emery, English-American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1958 — Gregg Edelman, American actor and singer
- 1957 — Rachel Ward, English-Australian actress
- 1993 — Kelsea Ballerini, American country pop singer
- 1966 — Darren E. Burrows, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 2013 — NASA confirms that its Voyager 1 probe has become the first manmade object to enter interstellar space.
- 1983 — A Wells Fargo depot in West Hartford, Connecticut, United States, is robbed of approximately US\$7 million by Los Macheteros.
- 2001 — Ansett Australia, Australia's first commercial interstate airline, collapses due to increased strain on the international airline industry, leaving 10,000 people unemployed.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2003 — The United Nations lifts sanctions against Libya after that country agreed to accept responsibility and recompense the families of victims in the 1988 bombing of Pan Am Flight 103.
- 2021 — Siberian Light Aviation Flight 51 crashes short of the runway at Kazachinskoye Airport, killing four.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1977 — South African anti-apartheid activist Steve Biko dies in police custody.
- 1980 — Florida Commuter Airlines Flight 65 crashes into the Atlantic Ocean off West End, Bahamas, killing 34 people.

- 2014 — Synagogue Church building collapse saw the deaths of 115 people and several injured, in the Church run by Nigeria's, T. B. Joshua.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 256 of the year, 109 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Cross (Assyrian Church of the East); Christian feast day: Aimé (Amatus); Christian feast day: Amé (Amatus) of Remiremont; Christian feast day: John Chrysostom. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Lloyd Dyer, English footballer
- 1967 — Stephen Perkins, American drummer and songwriter
- 1939 — Richard Kiel, American actor and voice artist (died 2014)
- 1977 — Fiona Apple, American singer-songwriter, producer, and pianist
- 1969 — Dominic Fumusa, American actor
- 1934 — Tony Pickard, English tennis player and coach
- 1979 — Tony Henry, English footballer
- 1954 — Isiah Whitlock Jr., American actor (died 2025)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1971 — Chairman Mao Zedong's second in command and successor Marshal Lin Biao flees China after the failure of an alleged coup. His plane crashes in Mongolia, killing all aboard.
- 1988 — Hurricane Gilbert is the strongest recorded hurricane in the Western Hemisphere, later replaced by Hurricane Wilma in 2005 (based on barometric pressure).
- 1986 — A magnitude 6.0 earthquake strikes Kalamata, Greece with a maximum Modified Mercalli intensity of X (Extreme), killing at least 20 and causing heavy damage in the city.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The IBM 305 RAMAC is introduced, the first commercial computer to use disk storage.
- 1982 — Spantax Flight 995 crashes at Málaga Airport during a rejected takeoff, killing 50 of the 394 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar